



OWNER'S GUIDE • NO. 01

Updating GLIDE

A new build is a file you copy to the card and install once. Ten minutes, start to finish — and everything you've made stays exactly where it is.

READ THIS
FIRST

To charge it, the side switch must be **ON**.

Plug in a switched-off Cardputer and nothing happens — no light, no charge, and it looks broken. It isn't. Switch it on first, then plug in. Full details overleaf.

WHAT YOU NEED

- Your **Cardputer**
- Its **microSD card** — the one already in it
- Any **computer**, Mac or Windows
- A way to plug the card in — an **SD adapter** or a card reader

WHAT IT TAKES

- About **ten minutes**
- No WiFi, no account, no software to install
- Nothing to back up first
- You can stop halfway and pick it up later

Your sounds are not in the app.

The ten slots, your saved tweaks, every setting, the two generative sounds unique to your device, and the odometer all live in the Cardputer's own memory — outside the program you're about to replace. Updating cannot touch them. The patch library on your card isn't touched either. There is nothing to back up, and nothing to restore afterwards.

THE WHOLE UPDATE, AT A GLANCE

01 Power off, pop the card out	02 Put the card in your computer	03 Download the newest GLIDE.bin
04 Drop it in the card's apps folder	05 Eject, and put the card back in	06 Power on, press a key to stay in Launcher
07 Delete the installed GLIDE	08 Return to the Launcher menu	09 SD → apps → GLIDE → Install

BEFORE

Power, charging, and the two triggers

day one

THE ONE THAT CATCHES EVERYBODY

A switched-off Cardputer does not charge. With the switch off the battery is disconnected entirely — the device just runs off the cable, and the cell ends the night exactly as empty as it started. Slide the switch to **ON** first, then plug in. This is how M5 built it; it is not a fault, and nothing is wrong with your device.

CHARGING IT

Switch **ON**, then plug USB-C into the port on the side. Any phone charger or computer port will do.

You can leave GLIDE running the whole time. It dims itself after a while and then drifts into a screensaver, so nothing is burning into the panel — and any key wakes it and plays the note, so the first touch back is never wasted.

THE TWO TRIGGERS, ON THE TOP EDGE

They look identical and they do completely different things. Worth learning once.

LEFT • MARKED BTN RST

Restarts the whole device. Nothing is lost — your sounds live in the Cardputer's memory, not in the program. This is the reliable way back to Launcher: press it, then tap any key as the device comes up. You will use it every time you update.

IF THE POWER LOOKS WRONG

► I plugged it in and nothing happened.

The side switch was off. Slide it to **ON** and plug in again — that's nearly always all it is.

► On battery it shows the Launcher logo, then restarts — over and over.

A completely flat battery, not a broken unit. Switch **ON**, plug in, choose **charge mode**, and give it a full hour — an empty cell charges slowly at first and can read full while plugged in. Trust the hour, not the number.

► I want to get out of GLIDE and back to Launcher.

Press the left trigger, **BTN RST**, then tap any key as the device comes back up. Holding  inside GLIDE only restarts GLIDE — you'll land back at its splash.

► The screen went dark on its own.

That's the idle dimming, and then the screensaver. Any key wakes it *and* plays the note, so the first touch back is never wasted. Settings → *Screen idle* turns it off if you'd rather.

WATCHING THE BATTERY

Below 25% the perform screen says so, and at 10% it blinks red — a pocket instrument should never die mid-jam without warning. Settings always shows the exact percentage if you want to check before heading out.

IF YOU WANT THE SCREEN OFF

Restart into Launcher, open **CFG**, and choose **charge mode**. The screen drops to a dim battery percentage and stays there — the tidiest way to leave it charging overnight on a desk.

press a key at the start screen

→ CFG

→ charge mode

PART ONE

Put the new file on the card

Steps 01-05

01 Power the Cardputer off, then pop the card out.

The microSD slot is spring-loaded: press the card *in* until it clicks, and it springs back out far enough to pull free. Don't try to pull it out without pressing first.

Power off first. Pulling a card out of a running device is how cards get corrupted.

02 Put the card in your computer.

If your computer has a full-size SD slot, seat the microSD card in an SD adapter and use that. Otherwise any USB card reader works. The card should appear like a USB stick.

03 Download the newest `GLIDE.bin`.

Open this link in your browser. It always points at the latest build, so it never goes stale — bookmark it.

github.com/CHARL3X/GLIDE-Synth-Cardputer-ADV/releases/latest/download/GLIDE.bin

Some browsers are suspicious of `.bin` files and ask whether to keep the download. Keep it. Note where it landed — usually your Downloads folder.

04 Drag it into the `apps` folder on the card.

Open the card, open the folder named `apps`, and drag the file you just downloaded into it. Your computer will ask whether to replace the file that's already there. Replace it.

KEEP THE NAME EXACTLY `GLIDE.BIN`

If your browser saved it as `GLIDE(1).bin` or `GLIDE-1.bin`, rename it to `GLIDE.bin` before or after you move it. A file with any other name will still show up on the device, but you'll be staring at two entries wondering which is which.

05 Eject the card properly, and put it back in the Cardputer.

Eject it from your computer first — on a Mac, drag it to the Trash or press eject; on Windows, use *Safely Remove Hardware*. Then slide the card back into the Cardputer the same way it came out, and press until it clicks and stays put.

Ejecting properly is what makes sure the file is actually finished writing. Skipping it is the most common cause of "the new version isn't there."

HALFWAY POINT — AND WHY PART TWO EXISTS

The new build is on the card now, but the Cardputer is still running the old one. GLIDE is *installed* onto the device — that's why it starts the moment you power on, instead of making you go and find it every time. A newer file on the card doesn't replace a copy that's already installed, so part two clears the old one out and installs the new one. And the clearing out matters: Launcher *adds* an app rather than replacing it, so installing without deleting first leaves you with two GLIDE tiles. Two minutes, all on the device.

PART TWO

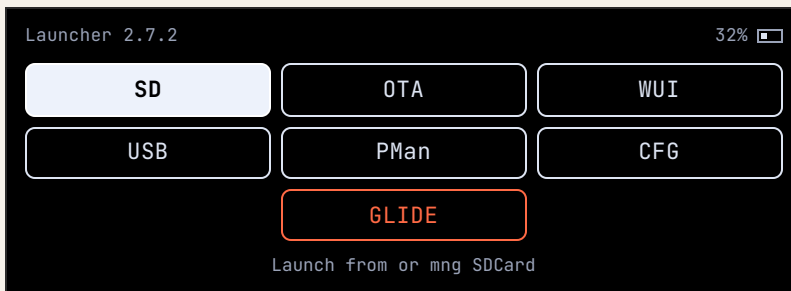
Swap the copy on the device

Steps 06-09

Screens drawn from Launcher 2.7.2. Later versions shuffle things around — the job stays the same.

06 Power on — and press any key immediately.

You have a couple of seconds. Press a key *before* the GLIDE splash appears and you'll stay in Launcher, which is the menu you need. If the synth starts up instead, you were too slow — press the **left trigger on the top edge, marked BTN RST**, which restarts the device, and tap a key as it comes back up. (Holding  inside GLIDE will not get you here: it restarts GLIDE, and you land right back at the splash.)



YOU'RE IN — SIX BUILT-IN TILES, AND GLIDE BELOW THEM

07 Move down to the GLIDE tile, and delete it.

GLIDE is the red tile on its own row at the bottom — it's in the picture above. Move down to it and select it, then choose **Delete** from the options that come up. Confirm if you're asked.

Don't skip this step. Launcher doesn't replace an installed app, it adds another one — install without deleting and you'll have two GLIDE tiles with nothing to tell them apart.

THIS DOES NOT DELETE YOUR SOUNDS

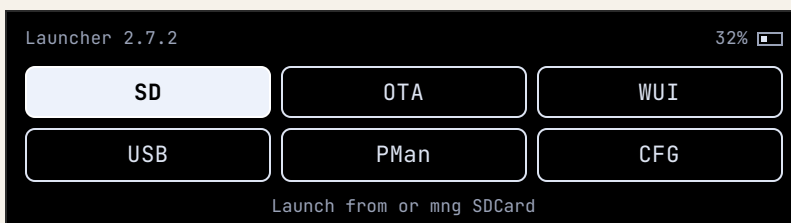
You're removing the *program*, not your work. Slots, settings, your two generative sounds and the odometer are stored separately and are untouched by this. They'll be exactly as you left them when the new version starts.

08 Get back to that same menu.

After the delete, return to the Launcher menu — press any key at the start screen again, the same way you did in step 06.

09 Select SD, then apps → GLIDE → install.

The **SD** tile is the card browser — its line at the bottom of the screen reads *Launch from or mng SDCard*. Open it, go into the **apps** folder, and select the **GLIDE** file you copied over in part one. Choose **Install** and let it finish. A few seconds; don't power it off while it works.



GLIDE'S TILE IS GONE NOW — THAT'S EXPECTED. SELECT SD.

DONE

Check it took

Power the Cardputer off and on. GLIDE starts, and the splash shows the version top-right. If that's the number you just downloaded, you're done — go and play it.



VERSION, TOP-RIGHT ON THE SPLASH

THE SHORTCUT, FOR NEXT TIME

Launcher can also fetch and install a new build over WiFi — no computer, no card shuffling. Press a key at the start screen, open **OTA**, join your network, pick GLIDE. Same result; the card stays as the fallback.

IF SOMETHING GOES SIDEWAYS

► GLIDE starts before I can press a key.

Press the left trigger on the top edge, marked **BTN RST** — it restarts the device — then tap a key as it comes up. Don't reach for  inside GLIDE: that restarts GLIDE and drops you back at its splash, not in Launcher.

► I don't see GLIDE in the card's apps folder on the device.

It's in the wrong folder or under a different name. Back in your computer: it must sit inside **apps**, named **GLIDE.bin**.

► The version on the splash didn't change.

Either the file never finished copying (eject properly next time), or part two didn't take. Run part two again — repeating it is safe.

► I deleted GLIDE and now there's nothing to play.

Nothing is lost — the program is on your card, your sounds are in the device. Go to step 09. If the card is the problem, re-download from page 3.

► The computer doesn't see the card at all.

Try another adapter, reader, or port — nearly always the reader. Decline any offer to "repair" or "format" it: that erases your patch library.

► I've got two GLIDE tiles now.

You installed without deleting first. Delete both, then install once from **SD** → **apps**. Your sounds don't care.

► The menus don't look quite like the pictures.

Launcher moves its labels around between versions. The job is the same: remove the installed GLIDE, then browse the card to **apps** and install from there.

Updates are free, and they always will be.

Every build is free, and your sounds carry across all of them. The manual, the release notes and the source live in the repo. The Discord is where people post the sounds their device rolled — and where to find me if you're stuck. I wrote this; I'll answer.

github.com/CHARL3X/GLIDE-Synth-Cardputer-ADV
discord.gg/uRcuJ6CeHG



SCAN • THE REPO



SCAN • THE DISCORD